RM Course Progression – CS 2024–26

OCR J277 • the order Robert MacGregor actually taught in

Cohort A • Y10 2024/25, Y11 2025/26 • sat papers summer 2026

This cohort has **left**. It is not the class inherited in August 2026 — that is the 2025–27 cohort, in its own document. Read this one as the **baseline**: what Robert did first, second and third when he had a full two years with a group. Every date comes from a dated OneNote page, so a row is evidence that a lesson happened, and a silence is not evidence that one did not. **Section rail order is not teaching order —** only the dates give the real sequence.

Date	Lesson (OneNote page)	Section	OCR
YEAR 1 — 2024/25 • slots Tue ∼14:45 / Thu ∼11:30			
Autumn 2024 — hardware, then data representation			
Tue 3 Sep	Computer hardware	1-Sys Arch	1.2.1–2
Thu 12 Sep	Computer hardware (2) · Activity — Secondary storage	1-Sys Arch	1.2.2
Tue 17 Sep	Embedded Systems	1-Sys Arch	1.1.3
Thu 10 Oct	Denary (decimal) and binary conversion	2-Data Rep	1.2.4
	— half-term, 12–23 Oct —		
Tue 29 Oct	Hexadecimal numbers and conversions	2-Data Rep	1.2.4
Thu 31 Oct	Adding binary numbers	2-Data Rep	1.2.4
Mon 4 Nov	Review quiz *(16:33, out of hours)*	2-Data Rep	1.2.4
Thu 7 Nov	Binary shifts and overflows	2-Data Rep	1.2.4
Tue 12 Nov	Character sets	2-Data Rep	1.2.4
Thu 14 Nov	Representing images	2-Data Rep	1.2.4
Tue 19 Nov	Representing images (2)	2-Data Rep	1.2.4
Thu 21 Nov	Representing sounds · Compression	2-Data Rep	1.2.4–5
Tue 3 Dec	Example	2-Data Rep	1.2.4–5
Thu 5 Dec	Network structures	3a Networks	1.3.1
Tue 10 Dec	Christmas coding challenge	Challenge	2.2
Spring 2025 — networks, then security ***and programming side by side***			
Tue 7 Jan	Network structures (2)	3a	1.3.1
Thu 9 Jan	Wired and wireless networks	3a	1.3.2
Tue 14 Jan	Recap — wired/wireless · Encryption, bluetooth, performance	3a	1.3.2
Tue 21 Jan	Network performance	3a	1.3.1
Thu 23 Jan	Network topologies	3a	1.3.1
Tue 28 Jan	Questions on networks	3a	1.3
Tue 4 Feb	Network Protocols	3a	1.3.2
Thu 6 Feb	Application protocols	3a	1.3.2
	— half-term —		
Tue 18 Feb	Protocols and layers	3a	1.3.2
Thu 20 Feb	Internet and DNS	3a	1.3.1
Tue 25 Feb	Cyber security threats *(14:49)* + Variables, constants and assignments *(15:44)*	3b + 7	1.4.1 + 2.2.1
Thu 27 Feb	Input, output, concatenation	7	2.2.1
Tue 4 Mar	Shouldering *(14:46)* + Quick quiz · Casting · Arithmetic operations *(15:38)*	3b + 7	1.4.1 + 2.2.1–2
Thu 6 Mar	Malware	3b	1.4.1
Tue 18 Mar	Revision resources *("for the test next week")*	3a revision	1.3
	*— **NETWORKS TEST**, week of 24 Mar —*		
Tue 25 Mar	Hacking	3b	1.4.1
Thu 27 Mar	Quiz	3b	1.4
Tue 1 Apr	Network security	3b	1.4.2
Summer 2025 — algorithms			
Thu 24 Apr	Easy: *(algorithm output tracing)*	6	2.1.2
Tue 29 Apr	Abstraction	6	2.1.1
Tue 13 May	Designing programs	6	2.1.2
Thu 22 May	Printout	6	2.1.2
Thu 19 Jun	Flowcharts	Revision	2.1.2
Tue 24 Jun	Flowcharts (2) · Flowchart questions · Trace tables	6	2.1.2
Thu 26 Jun	Trace table problems	6	2.1.2

Year 2 — 2025/26 • slots Mon / Wed, mornings • the exam year

Date	Lesson (OneNote page)	Section	OCR
Autumn 2025 — clear the small topics, then ethics			
Mon 1 Sep	Robust Systems	8	2.3.1
Wed 3 Sep	Activity — Code maintainability	8	2.3.1
Mon 8 Sep	Finding errors in code	8	2.3.2
Wed 10 Sep	Test plans	8	2.3.2
Wed 17 Sep	Boolean logic	9	2.4.1
Wed 24 Sep	Truth tables	9	2.4.1
Mon 29 Sep	Ethics questions	5	1.6.1
Wed 1 Oct	Keeping information private	5	1.6.1
∼6–10 Oct	Censorship, Surveillance… *(stamp deleted — placed by position)*	5	1.6.1
— half-term, ∼13–24 Oct —			
Wed 29 Oct	Harmful content and social media · How does technology shape our culture?	5	1.6.1
Mon 3 Nov	Health and technology · Business and a digital divide	5	1.6.1
Wed 5 Nov	Environmental issues	5	1.6.1
Mon 10 Nov	Computer legislation	5	1.6.1
Tue 18 Nov	Open source and Proprietary Software *(17:53, out of hours)*	5	1.6.1
Mon 1 Dec	Printout	7	2.2
***56-day gap**, 1 Dec → 26 Jan — Christmas plus ∼5 teaching weeks. The January **mock** window.*			
Spring 2026 — finish the syllabus			
Mon 26 Jan	Systems software	4	1.5.1
Wed 28 Jan	Systems software (2)	4	1.5.1
Mon 2 Feb	Systems software (3) — Utilities	4	1.5.2
Wed 4 Feb	More trace tables · Decomposition — structure diagrams	6	2.1.1–2
Mon 16 Feb	SQL — retrieving information · Random numbers	7	2.2.3
Wed 18 Feb	Searching and sorting	6	2.1.3
Mon 23 Feb	Recap · Bubble sort · Quiz	6	2.1.3
Wed 25 Feb	Translators and IDEs	7	2.5.1–2
Mon 2 Mar	Strings and string functions · Files	7	2.2.3
Tue 3 Mar	1st set of new qs (Paper 1) · An extra Paper 1 question (OS)	Revision	P1
Mon 23 Mar	Test 27	Revision	—
Summer 2026 — revision, then the papers			
Wed 22 Apr	**1.1 Architecture**	Revision	1.1.1–2
Mon 27 Apr	Coding	Revision	2.2.2
late May / early Jun	**OCR J277/01 and J277/02 sat**	—	—

What the baseline shows.

- **Hardware opened the course**, then data representation — and **1-Systems Architecture sits last in the OneNote rail**, which is why rail order misleads.
- **Programming was taught *side by side* with network security** in Feb–Mar 2025, two topics in the same week, not in a block. That is the same model Alex chose independently.
- **Year 2 was spent clearing small topics and revising**, not introducing large ones — robust systems, Boolean, ethics, then systems software. The heavy lifting was done in Year 1.
- Roughly **85 dated pages across two years**, against ∼140 slots. A silence is not proof a lesson did not happen.